

ChessEver — Promo Code Playbook

For the Product Manager. Step-by-step on generating, distributing, and tracking codes in App Store Connect and Google Play Console — plus the one Supabase decision you need to make for partner attribution.

TL;DR

The “Have a code?” flow is fully wired in the app. You can mint codes today and they will work — no engineering involvement needed. The **only** decision that affects backend setup is whether you want a code to credit a specific affiliate partner (see §6).

What's inside

1. How the *Have a code?* button works in the app
2. iOS — generating codes in App Store Connect
3. Android — generating codes in Google Play Console
4. Sharing codes with users & testing
5. Troubleshooting
6. Partner-attributed vanity codes (*optional, requires one DB row*)

App identifiers you'll need

Apple App ID	6752567269
iOS App Store URL	<code>https://apps.apple.com/us/app/chessever/id6752567269</code>
iOS direct-redeem URL template	<code>https://apps.apple.com/redeem?ctx=offerCodes&id=6752567269&code=<CODE></code>
Android direct-redeem URL template	<code>https://play.google.com/redeem?code=<CODE></code>

1. How the “Have a code?” button works

On every paywall in the ChessEver app, below the “Restore purchases” link, there is a “**Have a code?**” button. What happens when a user taps it depends on which device they are on:

iOS / iPad

Apple's official redemption window opens.

The user types the code into Apple's own UI. Apple validates it, charges the right amount (or marks it free), and starts the subscription. The ChessEver app instantly unlocks Premium when Apple confirms.

Android

A small ChessEver sheet asks for the code.

After they type it, the app opens the Play Store with that code already filled in. The user just taps *Redeem*. Coming back to ChessEver, Premium is unlocked automatically.

Important

Codes are **generated by the stores** (Apple and Google) — not by ChessEver. We do not manually create or enter codes anywhere in our backend. Your job is to use the store consoles to mint codes and share them.

2. iOS — App Store Connect

App Store Connect offers **two kinds** of codes. Pick the one that fits the use case:

Type	Best for	How users see it	Limits
Promo Codes	Press, reviewers, free giveaways, a few power users	Free version of a specific subscription / IAP	Up to 100 per quarter per app, expires in 28 days
Offer Codes	Marketing campaigns, win-back, partner deals	Discount, free trial, or pay-as-you-go offer	Up to 10 active offers per subscription, millions of codes per offer

A. Generating *Promo Codes* (free copy of subscription)

1. Sign in to `appstoreconnect.apple.com` with the ChessEver Apple ID.
2. Click **My Apps** → **ChessEver**.
3. In the left sidebar, open **Features** → **Promo Codes**.

4. **4** Click the **+** **button** next to the In-App Purchase you want to give away (e.g. *ChessEver Premium Annual*).
5. **5** Type how many codes you want (max 100 per quarter, shared across all IAPs).
6. **6** Agree to the terms → click **Generate**.
7. **7** Click **Download Codes**. Apple gives you a `.txt` file with one code per line.

Each code can only be used once. Codes expire 28 days after generation, whether redeemed or not.

B. Generating Offer Codes (discount or free trial)

1. **1** App Store Connect → **My Apps** → **ChessEver** → **Subscriptions** (under *In-App Purchases & Subscriptions*).
2. **2** Click the subscription product (e.g. *Premium Annual*).
3. **3** Scroll to **Subscription Offers** → click **Create Offer Code**.
4. **4** Fill out:
 - **Reference name** — internal label, e.g. *Holiday2026*.
 - **Eligibility** — New customers / Existing / Expired.
 - **Offer type** — Free, Pay as you go, or Pay up front.
 - **Duration** — e.g. 1 month free.
5. **5** Add the territories where the offer is valid.
6. **6** Choose how to deliver:
 - **One-time-use codes** — Apple generates a CSV with thousands of unique codes.
 - **Custom code** — One single shareable code (e.g. `CHESS50`) anyone can use, with a usage cap.
7. **7** Save → download the CSV (for one-time codes).

3. Android — Google Play Console

Google Play uses a single concept called **Promotions**. You can issue either one shareable code or a batch of unique codes.

Code style	Best for	Notes
One-time codes	Giveaways, individual gifting	Up to 500,000 codes per promotion. Each code works once.
Custom (vanity) code	Marketing campaigns, podcasts, partners	One code, e.g. <code>CHESS50</code> . You set the redemption cap.

Generating a Promotion

1. **1** Sign in to `play.google.com/console` with the ChessEver Google account.
2. **2** Pick the **ChessEver** app.
3. **3** In the left sidebar: **Monetize with Play** → **Promo codes**. (In some accounts this is under *Monetization setup* → *Promotions*.)
4. **4** Click **Create promo code**.
5. **5** Fill out:
 - **Promotion type** — One-time codes or Custom code.
 - **Promotion name** — internal label.
 - **Applicable products** — pick the subscription or IAP (e.g. *premium_annual*).
 - **Discount** — Free or Percentage off.
 - **Duration** — for free trials, how many days/months are free.
 - **Start & end date** — when codes can be redeemed.
 - **Number of codes** (one-time) or **max redemptions** (custom).
6. **6** Click **Create**.
7. **7** Download the CSV (one-time) or copy the single code (custom).

Heads-up about Android subscriptions:

Google Play promo codes for *subscriptions* only support **free trials** — you cannot give a percentage discount on a subscription via a promo code. For one-time products you can do free or % off.

4. Sharing codes & testing

How to share codes with users

- **iOS direct link (recommended for marketing):**

`https://apps.apple.com/redeem?ctx=offerCodes&id=6752567269&code=<THECODE>`

Opens the App Store with the code pre-filled. One tap to redeem.

- **iOS in-app:** User opens ChessEver → paywall → *Have a code?* → types it.
- **Android direct link:** `https://play.google.com/redeem?code=<THECODE>`
Opens Play Store with the code pre-filled.
- **Android in-app:** User opens ChessEver → paywall → *Have a code?* → types it. The app launches Play Store automatically.

Example messages you can send

iOS user:

Tap to claim 1 month of ChessEver Premium on us:

<https://apps.apple.com/redeem?ctx=offerCodes&id=6752567269&code=ABC123XYZ>

Android user:

Tap to claim 1 month of ChessEver Premium on us:

<https://play.google.com/redeem?code=ABC123XYZ>

Cross-platform / unknown device: share the raw code, e.g. “Open ChessEver, tap **Have a code?** on the upgrade screen, and enter `ABC123XYZ` .”

Testing before you ship codes to real users

1. Generate **one** code first.
2. On a real device, sign in with a *different* Apple ID / Google account than your developer account (sandbox / test accounts work).
3. Open ChessEver → paywall → *Have a code?* → enter the code.
4. Confirm Premium unlocks (the celebration animation plays and the paywall closes).
5. Cancel/refund the test code in the store console so the batch isn't reduced.

5. Troubleshooting

Problem	Likely cause	Fix
“Code not valid” on iOS	Code expired (28 days for promo codes), wrong region, or already redeemed	Generate a fresh code; verify the user's country is in the offer's territory list
Play Store says “Promotion not available”	Promotion not started yet, ended, or device country not allowed	Check start/end dates and country of the Google account
Code redeemed but Premium not unlocked	App didn't refresh entitlement	Force-close and reopen ChessEver. The app re-checks RevenueCat on resume and unlocks automatically.
Same code redeemed twice	One-time codes are single-use — second attempt fails	Issue a new code; for repeat use, set up a <i>custom/vanity</i> code with a usage cap
User on iOS sees a blank sheet	Older iOS versions or regional restriction	Ask user to redeem via the direct App Store link instead

Quick mental model

Apple and Google handle **billing, validation, and refunds**. ChessEver only listens for the “user is now subscribed” signal via RevenueCat and flips Premium on. So if a code works in the store, it works in the app — no engineering ticket needed.

6. Partner-attributed vanity codes (optional)

Everything above gets you working codes. This section only matters if you plan to give an **affiliate partner** a single shareable code (e.g. `JOHNCHESS`) and you want commissions to flow to them when anyone redeems it — even users who never clicked their tracking link.

How it works (one paragraph)

The app stamps the typed code onto the user's RevenueCat record. The webhook checks three places, in order, to figure out which affiliate to credit:

1. Did the user **install via an affiliate's tracking link**? → credit that affiliate.
2. Did they install via a tracking link *and* redeem a code? → credit the install affiliate.
3. Otherwise: does the typed code **match a known affiliate code in our DB**? → credit that affiliate.

Layer 3 is the new lever for partner vanity codes. To activate it for a given code, that exact string must exist in the `affiliates` table.

Setup checklist (per partner)

1. **1 Pick a code string.** Short, uppercase, no spaces. Example: `JOHNCHESS` or `PODCAST50`.
2. **2 Create the code in the store(s).**
 - **Android (recommended):** Play Console → Promo codes → *Custom code* with that exact string. Vanity attribution works fully on Android.
 - **iOS:** App Store Connect → Subscription Offer Codes → *Custom code* with the same string. *Note:* Apple's redemption sheet doesn't pass the typed code back to the app, so iOS attribution to a partner via vanity code only works if the user *also* installed via the partner's tracking link. For pure-organic iOS users redeeming a vanity code, you can still issue the code, but commission won't be auto-credited.
3. **3 Add a row to the `affiliates` table** in Supabase (only if the partner doesn't already have one with that exact code). The engineering team can do this in a single SQL command, or you can use the Supabase dashboard:

```
INSERT INTO affiliates (code, name, commission_rate, is_active)
VALUES ('JOHNCHESSE', 'John – Podcast partner', 0.30, true);
```

4. **4 Hand the code to the partner** along with the direct-redeem URLs from §4.
5. **5 Watch the affiliate dashboard** at `aff.chessever.com`. Conversions from this code will appear under that partner with status *pending* and clear after the refund window.

If you skip step 3, the code still works and unlocks Premium — but no partner gets credited. Use this when the code is internal-only (e.g. press, retention, win-back) and there is no commission to pay out.

What goes into the `affiliates` row

Column	What to put
<code>code</code>	The exact vanity code string. Must match the Play / ASC code character-for-character. Stored uppercase.
<code>name</code>	Internal label — partner name + campaign. e.g. <i>“John – Podcast partner”</i> .
<code>commission_rate</code>	Decimal share, default <code>0.30</code> (= 30 %). Edit per deal.
<code>is_active</code>	<code>true</code> . Set to <code>false</code> to retire the code (existing redemptions stay credited; new ones won't credit).
<code>email / payout_details</code>	Optional. Fill if you'll be paying this partner.

When in doubt, skip it

For everyday giveaways (press kits, internal team, retention save-saves) you don't need any of §6. Just generate codes in App Store Connect / Play Console and share them. The DB only enters the picture when you decide to pay someone for sharing them.